SEPARATE KEY

Pronunciation practice: key

These answers follow the guide's chosen reading convention. The English words identify particular sounds; they are not replacement spellings for whole Old English words. The permitted American **r** and practical short-vowel approximations are acceptable. Different scholarly reconstructions do not make all sound choices interchangeable within these exercises.

A. Length contrasts

A1. ac, "but"; āc, "oak". Ā in **āc** is long. Both vowels have the *father* quality; hold the second longer. Both final consonants are **k**. Do not replace **ā** with the English letter name **a**.

A2. is, "is"; īs, "ice". Ī in **īs** is long. Use *bit* for short **i**, held *see* for long **ī**. The selected practical vowels differ in quality as well as length. Both words end in unvoiced **s**, as in *sip*; modern English *is* does not determine Old English voicing.

A3. god, "god"; gōd, "good". Ō in **gōd** is long. The vowel of **god** is short and rounded, as described in the guide; **gōd** has the steady initial vowel of *go*, held without the glide. Retain hard **g** in both. Do not copy the vowels of the modern English glosses.

A4. full, "full"; fūl, "vile". Ū in **fūl** is long, with the *food* quality; **full** has short *foot*-type **u**. The target is this vowel-length and vowel-quality contrast. Both final **l** sounds have ordinary single-consonant duration; the written **ll** of **full** does not require extra holding.

B. Consonants and unfamiliar sounds

B1. cuman, "come". C is **k**, as in *kit*. It is a stopped sound, without the **ch** beginning heard in *chin*. The English gloss illustrates the initial consonant, not the whole Old English word.

B2. cyrice, "church". Both **c** letters have the **ch** sound of *chin*. Keep three syllables and the light final **e**. Short **y** remains the rounded-front vowel taught in the guide; the modern English gloss is not a complete pronunciation model.

B3. cēlan, "cool". C is **k**. This is a supplied exception to the front-vowel tendency. The following **ē** does not authorize changing it to **ch**.

B4. giefan, "give". Initial **g** is consonant **y**, as in *yes*. The following **ie** is the taught single-syllable glide beginning with the *see* vowel. Neither hard **g** nor the sound of English **j** is the requested initial sound.

B5. fugol, "bird". G is continuous and voiced: bring the back of the tongue near the hard-**g** position, leave a gap, and sustain the airflow with throat vibration. A complete closure would give a hard stop; omitting the sound would lose a consonant.

B6. scip, "ship". Sc is the single **sh** sound of *ship*. Do not pronounce separate **s** and **k** here. That separate pair belongs to the supplied exception **frosc**, "frog".

B7. niht, "night". Use the front, unvoiced continuous **h** sound: raise the middle of the tongue toward the roof of the mouth and let breath pass through the gap. Both **h** and **t** are audible. The modern gloss does not license a silent **h** or a long vowel.

B8. wyrt, "herb; plant". Y is a short rounded-front vowel. Keep the tongue position of *bit* while rounding the lips as for **oo** in *food*. Do not pull the tongue back into an ordinary **oo** sound or make the consonant **y** of *yes*.

C. Voice

C1. cnīf, "knife". Final **f** is unvoiced, as in *fan*. The preceding vowel does not voice a word-final **f** under this guide's rule. The initial **c** is also sounded, as **k**.

C2. cnīfas, "knives". F is voiced, as in *van*, between **ī** and **a**. This is the same written letter as in **cnīf**, now in a different sound environment. The final **s** remains unvoiced.

C3. rīsan, "rise". S is voiced, as in *zip*, because it stands between voiced vowels. Its spelling does not require the unvoiced sound of *sip* in this position.

C4. hūs, "house". Final **s** is unvoiced, as in *sip*. It remains unvoiced despite the preceding vowel. A voiced **z** is not the selected word-final reading.

C5. ōðer, "other". Ð is voiced, as in *this*, between vowels. The sound follows its environment here, not a distinction between the letters **ð** and **þ**.

C6. hælðu, "health". Ð is unvoiced, as in *thin*. Although **l** and **u** carry voice, this word is an explicitly supplied exception. Applying the ordinary surrounding-sounds rule without its stated limits would give the wrong target.

D. Syllables and stress

D1. habban, "have". Two syllables; stress the first. **Bb** is prolonged: hold the lip closure before releasing into the second syllable. There is no extra vowel or third syllable between the two written consonants.

D2. fugol, "bird". Two syllables; stress the first. There is no doubled consonant. Keep the second vowel audible and the medial **g** continuous and voiced; dropping the unstressed **o** is not the requested careful reading.

D3. heofonan, "heaven". Three syllables; stress the first. There is no doubled consonant. **Eo** forms one glide, followed by syllables containing **o** and **a**. Keep both unstressed vowels audible; copying the two syllables of modern *heaven* would lose a syllable.

D4. gescēop, "created". Two syllables; stress the second, **scēop**. There is no doubled consonant. The prefix **ge-** is unstressed; long **ēo** remains one vowel glide within the stressed syllable. Two vowel letters do not create two syllables there.

E. A sentence adapted from Cook

The supplied meaning is "God created heaven and earth." No independent translation is tested.

E1. gescēop, "created". G has the sound of **y** in *yes*; **sc** has **sh**. The prefix contains a light **e**; the stressed second syllable contains long **ēo**, moving from a held, steady *day*-type vowel toward **oo**. Keep the prefix vowel: **g** and **sc** are not adjacent sounds with no vowel between them.

E2. heofonan, "heaven". F is voiced, as in *van*, between the **eo** glide and the following **o**, both voiced vowels. Keep three syllables, with stress on the first. The rule depends on surrounding sounds, not on the modern English spelling of the gloss.

E3. eorðan, "earth". Ð is voiced, as in *this*, between voiced **r** and **a**. The rule is "between voiced sounds", not only "between vowels". Keep the initial **eo** glide and the second syllable; the single-syllable English gloss is not a pronunciation model.